

CASE ID: 200404710020

EPISODE NAME: Dalai Lama Visits Canada 2004

2004/04/14 - 2005/04/14

Sender: China (710)

Target: Canada (20)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Stalemate in the Threat Stage (4)

Summary:

On 2004/04/14, China threatened Canada after Prime Minister Paul Martin announced a meeting with the Dalai Lama.¹ Despite threats, Martin went forward with the meeting, which occurred on 2004/04/23.² The incident did not damage relations.

Narrative:

On 2004/04/14, Canada's Chinese Embassy released a statement denouncing the Dalai Lama's upcoming visit to Ottawa.³ During this visit, the Dalai Lama was scheduled to meet with Canadian Prime Minister Paul Martin, which would be the first time a Canadian head-of-government had met with the spiritual and religious leader.⁴ The Chinese statement warned that the meeting would constitute a "drastic departure from Canada's current policy on the issue of Tibet, and it will be construed by his followers as an encouragement to his separatist activities."⁵ Additionally, it threatened that Canada "would damage trade relations by going ahead with the meeting."⁶ The nature of the economic sanctions were not specified.

On 2004/04/18, The Dalai Lama arrived in Canada for a 19-day tour through Vancouver, Toronto, and Ottawa.⁷ On 2004/04/23, Archbishop Marcel Gervais of Ottawa hosted a meeting between Prime Minister Martin and the Dalai Lama in his home.⁸ Gervais said the issue of Tibetan independence was not broached during the meeting, while Martin claimed they had a brief discussion about human rights in Tibet. In response to the Chinese statement, a

¹ UPI. "China Warns Canada on Dalai Lama Meeting", *UPI*, April 14th, 2004.

https://www.upi.com/Top_News/2004/04/14/China-warns-Canada-on-Dalai-Lama-meeting/11871081965742/.

² "Ottawa archbishop welcomes Dalai Lama and Canadian prime minister", *Catholic News Agency*, May 3, 2004.

<https://www.catholicnewsagency.com/news/1080/ottawa-archbishop-welcomes-dalai-lama-and-canadian-prime-minister>.

³ "China Warns Canada on Dalai Lama Meeting", *UPI*, April 14th, 2004.

https://www.upi.com/Top_News/2004/04/14/China-warns-Canada-on-Dalai-Lama-meeting/11871081965742/.

⁴ *Ibid*

⁵ *Ibid*

⁶ *Ibid*

⁷ "Dalai Lama Arrives in Canada for Visit", *Phayul*, April 18, 2004. <https://www.phayul.com/2004/04/18/6618/>.

⁸ "Ottawa archbishop welcomes Dalai Lama and Canadian prime minister", *Catholic News Agency*, May 3, 2004. <https://www.catholicnewsagency.com/news/1080/ottawa-archbishop-welcomes-dalai-lama-and-canadian-prime-minister>.

spokesperson for the Prime Minister claimed Martin was meeting with the Dalai Lama as a spiritual, not political, leader.⁹

On 2004/05/05, the Dalai Lama departed from Canada.¹⁰ The threats from China were left unfulfilled.

⁹ AFP. "China Lashes out at Canada for Allowing Visit", *Taipei Times*. April 16th, 2004.
<https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/world/archives/2004/04/16/2003136867>.

¹⁰ "Dalai Lama ends visit to Canada", *The Globe and Mail*, May 5, 2004.
<https://www.theglobeandmail.com/news/national/dalai-lama-ends-visit-to-canada/article1135657/>.